

Monopoly: Complete Rules Guide

A comprehensive guide to the standard/classic Monopoly board game, covering setup, turns, property, rent, building, Jail, cards, mortgages, trading, bankruptcy, and common house rules.

1. The Objective

The goal of Monopoly is to become the last player who has not gone bankrupt. You do this by moving around the board, buying properties, charging rent, building houses and hotels, managing your money, and avoiding bankruptcy.

2. What Comes With the Game?

- The game board
- Player tokens
- Two dice
- Money
- Title Deed cards
- Chance cards
- Community Chest cards
- Houses
- Hotels

Exact artwork, property names, money denominations, and some cards can differ between editions, but the basic rules are broadly the same.

3. Setting Up the Game

Choose one player to be the Banker. The Banker manages the Bank's money, pays players when required, collects payments owed to the Bank, sells houses and hotels, and manages Title Deed cards. The Banker may also play, but must keep the Bank's money separate from their personal money.

In the classic game, each player starts with \$1,500:

- \$500 × 2
- \$100 × 4
- \$50 × 1
- \$20 × 1
- \$10 × 2
- \$5 × 1
- \$1 × 5

Each player chooses a token and places it on GO. Shuffle the Chance and Community Chest cards and place them face down in their spaces.

4. Who Goes First?

Each player rolls both dice. The player with the highest total goes first. Play then proceeds clockwise around the board.

5. Rolling the Dice

On your turn, roll both dice, move the number of spaces shown, and resolve the space you land on. If you roll doubles, you get another turn after completing the current turn.

Three doubles in a row

If you roll doubles three times consecutively during the same turn, you are sent immediately to Jail. You do not complete the movement associated with the third roll.

6. Passing GO

Whenever you move around the board and pass or land on GO, you collect \$200 from the Bank. If a card sends you directly to Jail, you do not collect \$200 for passing GO.

7. Buying Properties

Purchasable spaces include colored properties, four railroads, and two utilities. When you land on an unowned property, you may buy it from the Bank for the printed price and take its Title Deed.

8. If You Don't Buy an Unowned Property

Under the official rules, if you land on an unowned property and decline to buy it, the Bank auctions it immediately. All players may bid, including the player who declined to buy it. Bidding can start at any amount, including \$1. The highest bidder pays the Bank and receives the property.

9. Landing on Another Player's Property

If you land on a property owned by another player, you normally pay the rent shown on the property's Title Deed. If the property is mortgaged, no rent can be collected.

The owner must ask for rent

The owner must request rent before the next player rolls. If they fail to do so, the opportunity to collect that rent is lost under the standard rule.

10. Owning a Complete Color Group

Owning every property in a color group gives you a monopoly. If the properties are unimproved, the rent on those properties is generally doubled. A complete color group also allows you to build houses and hotels, subject to the building rules.

11. Building Houses

Once you own a complete color group, you can buy houses from the Bank at the price printed on the Title Deed.

Build evenly

Buildings must be constructed evenly across a color group. For a three-property group, examples of permitted progress include 1/1/1, 2/1/1, 2/2/1, and 2/2/2. You cannot build three houses on one property while leaving the others at zero.

Maximum of four houses

A property can have a maximum of four houses before it can potentially be upgraded to a hotel.

12. Building Hotels

A hotel replaces the four houses on a property. Pay the hotel price shown on the Title Deed and return the four houses to the Bank. The property then has a hotel and normally produces the highest rent available for that property.

13. When You Can Build

Under the standard rules, once you own a complete color group, you can buy buildings during your turn or between other players' turns, provided you obey the even-building rules and the Bank has the required buildings.

14. House Shortages

There is a limited number of houses. If the Bank has no houses available, you cannot simply create more. If multiple players want the last available houses, the official rules use an auction to determine who gets them.

15. If the Bank Runs Out of Money

The Bank cannot go bankrupt. If the physical money runs out, the Banker can create additional money using paper, bookkeeping, or another substitute.

16. Railroads

There are four railroads. Rent increases with the number of railroads the owner possesses:

Railroads owned	Rent
1	\$25
2	\$50
3	\$100
4	\$200

17. Utilities

If you land on a utility owned by another player, rent depends on the dice roll that caused you to land there.

- One utility owned: rent = $4 \times$ the dice total.
- Both utilities owned: rent = $10 \times$ the dice total.

For example, with a dice total of 8, one utility produces \$32 rent and both utilities produce \$80.

18. Chance and Community Chest

Landing on Chance means drawing a Chance card; landing on Community Chest means drawing a Community Chest card. Read the card and follow its instructions. Cards may give or take money, move you, send you to Jail, or provide a Get Out of Jail Free card.

19. Get Out of Jail Free Cards

A Get Out of Jail Free card may be used to leave Jail. After use, return it to the appropriate deck. Such a card may also be traded to another player for an agreed price.

20. Going to Jail

You can be sent to Jail by landing on Go to Jail, drawing a card that sends you to Jail, or rolling doubles three times consecutively.

21. Just Visiting

If normal movement places you on the Jail space, you are 'Just Visiting' and are not considered to be in Jail.

22. Getting Out of Jail

- Pay \$50 and then leave Jail and roll normally.
- Use a Get Out of Jail Free card.
- Attempt to roll doubles on up to three turns. If you roll doubles, leave Jail and move according to that roll. If you fail on all three attempts, pay \$50 and move according to the third roll.

23. Activities While in Jail

Being in Jail does not prevent you from collecting rent, trading, buying or selling property, mortgaging property, or buying buildings where permitted. The main restriction is that you do not move normally around the board until you get out.

24. Free Parking

Under the official rules, Free Parking does nothing. Landing there does not award money.

A popular house rule puts taxes and certain payments into the middle of the board and awards the accumulated money to whoever lands on Free Parking. This is not an official rule and can make games considerably longer.

25. Taxes

If you land on a tax space, pay the amount specified by your edition's board or rules. Different editions have used different Income Tax formulations, so follow the wording in your particular edition. Tax payments go to the Bank under the official rules.

26. Mortgaging Properties

If you need money, you can mortgage a property to the Bank for its printed mortgage value. While mortgaged, the property produces no rent and cannot be developed, but you still own it.

27. Paying Off a Mortgage

To unmortgage a property, pay the mortgage value plus the required interest. The classic rules use 10% interest. Once paid, the property can generate rent again.

28. Buildings and Mortgages

You generally cannot mortgage a property while there are buildings on its color group. Buildings must first be sold back to the Bank. Selling buildings is also subject to the even-selling rule.

29. Selling Houses and Hotels

Buildings can be sold back to the Bank for half of their purchase price. For example, a \$100 house returns \$50.

30. Trading Properties

Players may negotiate trades involving properties, cash, Get Out of Jail Free cards, and combinations of these. A property with buildings on it must have those buildings removed according to the rules before the property can be traded.

31. Trading Mortgaged Properties

Mortgaged properties can be traded. The receiving player must handle the mortgage according to the edition's mortgage rules, including any required interest payments.

32. Negotiating Deals

Players can negotiate and make arrangements, but the safest approach is to complete trades immediately rather than rely on complicated promises about future payments or rent.

33. Bankruptcy

If you owe more money than you can pay, you must try to raise the money by using your assets according to the rules. This can include selling buildings, mortgaging properties, trading assets, and using available cash. If you still cannot pay, you are bankrupt and eliminated.

34. Bankruptcy to Another Player

If another player is the person you owe, your remaining assets are transferred to that player according to the bankruptcy rules. This can include cash, properties, and applicable mortgaged properties.

35. Bankruptcy to the Bank

If you owe the Bank and cannot pay, your properties return to the Bank and are handled according to the rules, including being available for auction where applicable. You are eliminated.

36. What Happens After Bankruptcy?

A bankrupt player's token leaves the game. They no longer take turns, collect rent, or participate in trades. The remaining players continue until only one player remains financially solvent.

37. Lending Money

The standard rules do not provide for ordinary private loans between players. Players can trade assets, but a private loan arrangement is not a normal game mechanic.

38. Borrowing From the Bank

Players cannot simply borrow money from the Bank and promise to repay it later. The Bank pays or collects money only when the rules require it.

39. Selling Property Back to the Bank

The Bank normally does not buy properties back from players. Players can mortgage properties or trade them to other players. Buildings, however, can be sold back to the Bank for half price.

40. Building With Mortgaged Properties

You cannot build on a color group if any property in that group is mortgaged. All properties in the group must be eligible for development.

41. Rent on Other Properties in a Mortgaged Group

Mortgaging one property does not automatically stop rent on the other properties in the same color group. The mortgaged property itself produces no rent.

42. Landing on Your Own Property

Nothing happens. You do not pay yourself.

43. Landing on a Mortgaged Property

Nothing happens because the owner cannot collect rent from a mortgaged property.

44. Movement Cards

Some cards instruct you to move to a particular location, move backward, or advance to GO. Follow the exact wording of the card. If movement takes you past GO, you normally collect \$200 unless the card says otherwise.

45. Advance to GO

If a card tells you to advance to GO, move to GO and collect \$200.

46. Go Back Three Spaces

Move exactly three spaces backward and resolve the space where you land. If that space is Chance or Community Chest, draw the appropriate card.

47. The Bank's Property Supply

There is a fixed number of each property. The Bank cannot sell duplicate copies. Properties become available again only through rules such as bankruptcy returning them to the Bank.

48. Money Flow

Transaction	Money moves
Property purchase	Player → Bank
Rent	Player → Property owner
Tax	Player → Bank
Passing/landing on GO	Bank → Player

49. Complete Example Turn

Imagine you are on St. James Place. You roll $4 + 2 = 6$ and land on an unowned property costing \$180. You decide to buy it, pay the Bank \$180, and take its Title Deed. Your turn ends. If the roll had been doubles, you would roll again.

50. Example of Landing on an Opponent's Property

You roll $5 + 4 = 9$ and land on another player's property. The Title Deed says the rent is \$28. The owner asks for \$28, you pay them, and your turn ends. If you rolled doubles, you would roll again after resolving the rent.

51. Example of Completing a Monopoly

Suppose you own all three orange properties. You can now buy houses. If each house costs \$100, you could build 1/1/1 for \$300, then 2/1/1 for another \$100, continuing evenly until the properties have four houses each and can potentially be upgraded to hotels.

52. The Basic Game Cycle

Roll → Move → Resolve the space → Buy/trade/build/pay → Next player. As the game progresses, properties become monopolies, monopolies become developed with houses and hotels, rents increase, players run out of

money, and bankruptcies occur until one player remains.

53. Common House Rules That Are Not Official

House rule	Official?
Free Parking jackpot	No
Skipping auctions	No
Bonus for landing directly on GO	No
Putting taxes into Free Parking	No
Owner loses rent if they forget and the next player rolls	Yes, under the standard rule

54. Quick Reference

Situation	What happens
Pass GO	Collect \$200
Land on GO	Collect \$200
Unowned property	Buy it or auction it
Opponent's property	Pay rent
Opponent's mortgaged property	No rent
Your own property	Nothing
Chance	Draw Chance card
Community Chest	Draw Community Chest card
Tax	Pay Bank
Free Parking	Nothing officially
Go to Jail	Go directly to Jail
Roll doubles	Roll again
Three doubles	Go to Jail
Complete color group	Can build
Build houses	Build evenly
Four houses	Can potentially upgrade to hotel
Sell building	Receive half purchase price
Mortgage property	Receive mortgage value
Mortgaged property	No rent
Bankruptcy	Eliminated
Last solvent player	Wins

55. Official Rules vs. House Rules

There are two versions of Monopoly rules you will commonly encounter: the official rules printed by the publisher, and house rules invented by families or groups. The biggest differences often involve Free Parking jackpots, skipping auctions, bonus payments for landing on GO, and various pot rules. Before playing, agree on which house rules, if any, you will use.

Edition note: Property prices, rents, tax wording, card wording, and some mortgage details can vary between Monopoly editions. For an exact edition-specific guide, use the rule sheet included with that edition.